

RH09

Prajamandals, Press, Freedom Fighters & Integration of Rajasthan

About 2-3 questions a paper, more than any other chapter here. The integration sequence alone was asked in 2013, 2018, 2023 and 2024. Newspapers were asked in 2013, 2016, 2018, 2021 and 2024. Prajamandals in 2016 and 2023.

This is the single highest-yield chapter in Rajasthan History. It has three examinable blocks — which Prajamandal was founded where and by whom, which newspaper was edited by whom, and the seven stages by which twenty-two units became one Rajasthan. All three are pure matching. All three come back paper after paper.

Freedom Movement & Integration

Umbrella bodies

- Rajputana Madhya Bharat Sabha 1918
- Rajasthan Seva Sangh 1919
- AISPC 1927
- Deshi Rajya Lok Parishad 1931

Revolutionaries

- Arjun Lal Sethi
- Kesari Singh Barhath
- Jorawar Singh Barhath
- Pratap Singh Barhath
- Rao Gopal Singh Kharwa

Prajamandals

- Jaipur 1931 — first
- Marwar 1934
- Bikaner 1936
- Mewar 1938
- Sirohi 1939
- Dungarpur 1944

Gandhians

- Jai Narayan Vyas
- Manikya Lal Verma
- Gokul Bhai Bhatt
- Heera Lal Shastri
- Bhogilal Pandya

Press

- Mazahrul-Saroor 1849
- Rajasthan Kesari 1920
- Naveen Rajasthan 1922
- Tyag Bhumi 1927
- Agnibaan

Integration — 7 stages

- Matsya 18 Mar 1948
- Rajasthan Union 25 Mar 1948
- Sanyukt 18 Apr 1948
- Vrihad 30 Mar 1949
- Sanyukt Vrihad 15 May 1949
- Rajasthan 26 Jan 1950
- Punargathit 1 Nov 1956

What a Prajamandal was — get the idea before the list

The Congress worked in British India. It did not, as a rule, agitate inside princely states. So the people of Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur and the rest needed their own organisation. That organisation is the Prajamandal — literally 'people's circle'.

A Prajamandal asked for responsible government under the ruler, civil liberties, and an end to feudal levies. It was usually banned, its leaders jailed, and it revived. Its work fed straight into the integration of 1948-49 — the same men who led Prajamandals became the first Prime Ministers of the unions.

- Jaipur Prajamandal (1931) is the FIRST Prajamandal of Rajasthan.
- Founder: Kapoor Chand Patni.
- It was reorganised in 1936-38 under Heera Lal Shastri, with Jamnalal Bajaj's backing.
- Bundi's Prajamandal was also founded in 1931 — but Jaipur is the answer to 'first'.

Two founders you must not swap. Mewar's Prajamandal (1938) was founded by Manikya Lal Verma — the same man who came out of Bijolia. Marwar's (1934) is associated with Jai Narayan Vyas along with Bhanwar Lal Sarraf. Bikaner's (1936) was founded by Magharam Vaidya, and here is the detail RPSC likes: it had to be founded OUTSIDE the state, at Calcutta, because Bikaner banned political activity.

Prajamandal, founder, year — the full state-by-state table

Learn this in two halves. The 1930s half contains the big states and gets asked most. The 1940s half is thinner and mostly matters for Dungarpur and Jaisalmer.

Prajamandals, part 1 — 1931 to 1938

State	Year	Founder / leading name
Jaipur	1931	Kapoor Chand Patni (first in Rajasthan); reorganised by Heera Lal Shastri
Bundi	1931	Kantilal, Rishidutt Mehta
Marwar (Jodhpur)	1934	Jai Narayan Vyas, Bhanwar Lal Sarraf
Bikaner	1936	Magharam Vaidya — founded at Calcutta
Dholpur	1936	—
Mewar (Udaipur)	1938	Manikya Lal Verma
Alwar	1938	Hari Narayan Sharma
Bharatpur	1938	Gopilal Yadav
Karauli	1938	—
Shahpura	1938	Ramesh Chandra Ojha, Laduram Vyas

Prajamandals, part 2 — 1939 to 1946

State	Year	Founder / leading name
Kishangarh	1939	—
Sirohi	1939	Gokul Bhai Bhatt — 'the Gandhi of Rajasthan'
Kota	1939	Pandit Nayanuram Sharma
Banswara	1943	—
Dungarpur	1944	Bhogilal Pandya
Jaisalmer	1945	Mithalal Vyas
Pratapgarh	1945	—
Jhalawar	1946	—

Some of the Marwar detail is separately examinable. The Marwar Hitkarini Sabha was set up in 1938 and later became the Marwar Lok Parishad. Balmukund Bissa died in jail in 1942 during the Marwar agitation.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a match-the-following — Prajamandal to leader. The four names that recur are Kapoor Chand Patni (Jaipur), Jai Narayan Vyas (Marwar), Manikya Lal Verma (Mewar), Magharam Vaidya (Bikaner).

TRAP

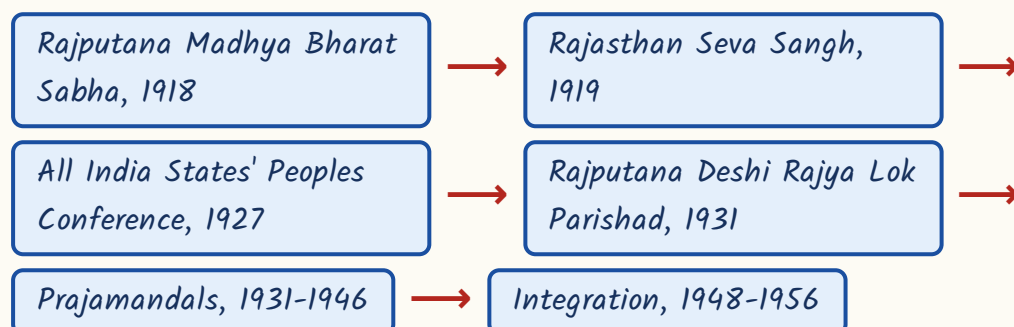
'Kota - Manikya Lal Verma' is a classic wrong pair. Kota's Prajamandal is Pandit Nayanuram Sharma. Manikya Lal Verma belongs to Mewar.

Two nicknames will fetch you two states for free. Gokul Bhai Bhatt is 'the Gandhi of Rajasthan' and he means Sirohi. Bhogilal Pandya is the builder of tribal education in the Vagad region and he means Dungarpur.

The umbrella bodies — how the movement organised itself

Before the Prajamandals there were regional and all-India bodies that gave the princely-state movements a platform. Learn them as a chain, because their years run in a neat sequence.

How the movement built itself up



- *Rajputana Madhya Bharat Sabha* — 1918, formed at the Delhi session of the Congress under Jamnalal Bajaj's lead; headquarters Ajmer.
- *Rajasthan Seva Sangh* — founded 1919 at Wardha by Vijay Singh Pathik; shifted to Ajmer in 1920.
- *All India States' Peoples Conference* — founded 1927 at Bombay; Vijay Singh Pathik was among its office-bearers.
- Nehru presided over the AISPC's Ludhiana session of 1939.
- *Rajputana Deshi Rajya Lok Parishad* — first session at Ajmer, 1931, presided over by Ram Narayan Chaudhary.

Notice how often Ajmer appears. Ajmer was British territory, so political work was legal there. That is why the Seva Sangh moved to Ajmer, why the Madhya Bharat Sabha was headquartered there, and why Rajasthan's nationalist press was printed there.

The press — newspaper, editor, place, year

RPSC has asked a newspaper question in almost every recent paper. The trick is that three or four papers share the same two or three editors, so you must learn the pairs, not just the names.

Newspapers of the Rajasthan freedom movement

Newspaper	Editor / founder	Place	Year
Mazahrul-Saroor	—	Bharatpur	1849 — earliest newspaper of Rajasthan
Rajputana Gazette	Maulvi Murad Ali	Ajmer	1885
Rajasthan Kesari	Vijay Singh Pathik (financed by Jamnalal Bajaj)	Wardha	1920
Naveen Rajasthan	Vijay Singh Pathik — organ of the Rajasthan Seva Sangh	Ajmer	1922

Newspaper	Editor / founder	Place	Year
Tarun Rajasthan	Ram Narayan Chaudhary, Jai Narayan Vyas	Ajmer	1923
Tyag Bhumi	Haribhau Upadhyaya	Ajmer	1927
Agnibaan	Jai Narayan Vyas	Beawar	—
Akhand Bharat	Jai Narayan Vyas	Bombay	1938
Pratap	Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi	Kanpur	Carried the Bijolia cause

Tyag Bhumi is the most examinable of these. It was the most influential nationalist weekly of Rajasthan, and its editor Haribhau Upadhyaya later became Chief Minister of Ajmer state, from 1952 to 1956.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — who was the editor of 'Tyag Bhumi'? Answer: Haribhau Upadhyaya. The linked statement question adds that it began in 1927 and that Upadhyaya became Chief Minister of Ajmer state.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 — 'Mazahrul-Saroor', regarded as the earliest newspaper of Rajasthan, was published from? Answer: Bharatpur, 1849.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 as a match-the-following on newspapers and editors. The safest anchors are Tyag Bhumi-Upadhyaya, Naveen Rajasthan-Pathik, Agnibaan-Jai Narayan Vyas, Rajputana Gazette-Maulvi Murad Ali.

Here is the false pair RPSC plants. Jai Narayan Vyas published Agnibaan, Akhand Bharat and Tarun Rajasthan. He did NOT publish Tyag Bhumi — that is

Haribhau Upadhyaya. 'Which newspaper was NOT published by Jai Narayan Vyas' is a live question and Tyag Bhumi is the answer.

Pathik's two papers are both 'Rajasthan' papers — Rajasthan Kesari (Wardha, 1920) and Naveen Rajasthan (Ajmer, 1922). Kesari came first and from Wardha, the same place where he had founded the Rajasthan Seva Sangh a year earlier. That link between the man, the town and the year is worth memorising as a unit.

The revolutionaries — Sethi and the Barhaths

Rajasthan also had an armed revolutionary strand, centred on Shahpura and Jaipur, and linked to the Delhi and Banaras conspiracies. It is a small group of names, so learn each one with the single act that fixes it.

- Arjun Lal Sethi — founded the Vardhaman Vidyalyaya at Jaipur in 1907, and the Jain Shiksha Prachark Samiti.
- Kesari Singh Barhath of Shahpura — wrote 'Chetavani ra Chungatya' (1903), thirteen sorthas urging Maharana Fateh Singh to boycott the Delhi Durbar.
- Kesari Singh also founded the Veer Bharat Sabha and was jailed at Hazaribagh.
- Jorawar Singh Barhath — took part in the bomb attack on Viceroy Lord Hardinge in Delhi, 23 December 1912.
- Pratap Singh Barhath — died of torture in Bareilly Central Jail.
- Rao Gopal Singh Kharwa — a leading revolutionary figure of Ajmer-Merwara.
- Sagarmal Gopa of Jaisalmer — wrote 'Jaisalmer ka Gundaraj' and 'Azadi ke Diwane'; died in jail on 4 April 1946.

YAAD RAKHO

Three Barhaths, three fates: Kesari Singh wrote (Chetavani ra Chungatya), Jorawar Singh bombed (Hardinge, 1912), Pratap Singh died (Bareilly jail).
Father, brother, son — write, bomb, die.

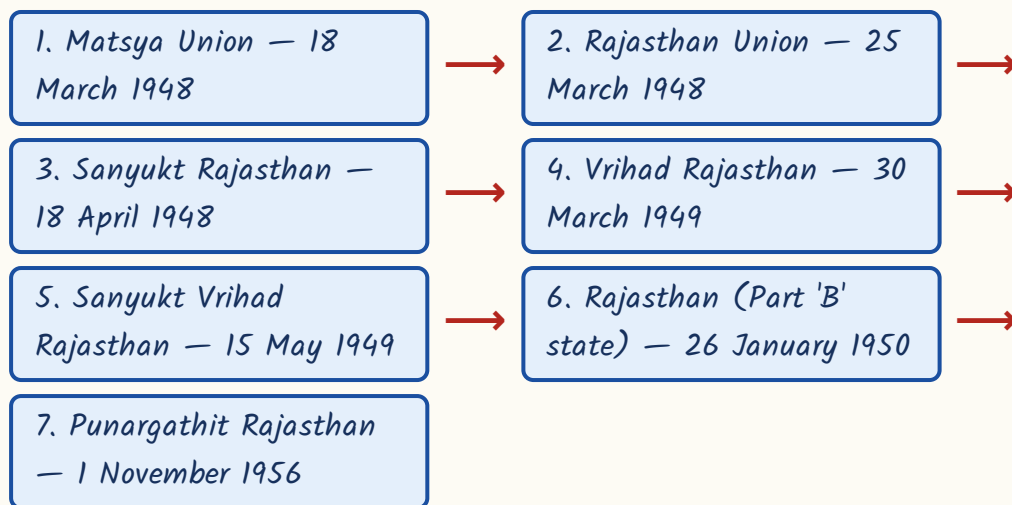
Alongside them stood the Gandhian leaders — Gokul Bhai Bhatt of Sirohi, called 'the Gandhi of Rajasthan'; Jai Narayan Vyas of Marwar; Heera Lal Shastri of Jaipur; Balwant Singh Mehta and Manikya Lal Verma of Mewar; Gokul Lal Asawa of Shahpura; and Ram Narayan Chaudhary. And the women: Ratan Devi and Anjana Devi Chaudhary of the Bijolia and Begun movements, Kishori Devi, Narayani Devi Verma, Rama Devi and Nagendra Bala.

Integration — the seven stages, in order, with dates

This is the most asked single item in Rajasthan History. RPSC does not ask you what happened at each stage. It asks you to put the stages in order, or to match a stage to its Rajpramukh or its Prime Minister. So learn the sequence as a sequence.

The logic is simple: the small eastern states merged first, the big states last, and Ajmer last of all. Three unions formed in 1948, two mergers in 1949, statehood in 1950, and the final shape in 1956.

The seven stages of the integration of Rajasthan



Stage by stage — what joined, who headed it

Stage & date	What joined	Rajpramukh	Prime Minister / note
1. Matsya Union, 18 Mar 1948	Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli + Neemrana chiefship. Capital Alwar	Udaybhan Singh of Dholpur	Shobha Ram; inaugurated by N.V. Gadgil
2. Rajasthan Union, 25 Mar 1948	Kota, Bundi, Tonk, Jhalawar, Dungarpur, Banswara, Pratapgarh, Kishangarh, Shahpura + Kushalgarh. Capital Kota	Bhim Singh of Kota	Gokul Lal Asawa
3. Sanyukt Rajasthan, 18 Apr 1948	Udaipur joined. Capital Udaipur	Maharana Bhupal Singh	Manikya Lal Verma; inaugurated by Jawaharlal Nehru
4. Vrihad Rajasthan, 30 Mar 1949	Jaipur, Jodhpur, Bikaner, Jaisalmer joined. Capital Jaipur	Sawai Man Singh II; Maharajpramukh Bhupal Singh	Heera Lal Shastri; inaugurated by Sardar Patel
5. Sanyukt Vrihad Rajasthan, 15 May 1949	Matsya Union merged in	Sawai Man Singh II	On the Shankar Rao Deo committee's recommendation
6. Rajasthan, 26 Jan 1950	Sirohi merged; Abu and Delwara went to Bombay. Part 'B' state	Sawai Man Singh II	Heera Lal Shastri becomes first Chief Minister

Stage & date	What joined	Rajpramukh	Prime Minister / note
7. Punargathit Rajasthan, 1 Nov 1956	Ajmer-Merwara, Abu Road and Delwara added; Sunel Tappa gained; Sironj lost to MP	Rajpramukh abolished by the 7th Amendment	Gurumukh Nihal Singh first Governor; Mohan Lal Sukhadia CM

YAAD RAKHO

Two chants. Dates: 18-3-48, 25-3-48, 18-4-48, 30-3-49, 15-5-49, 26-1-50, 1-11-56 — three in 1948, two in 1949, Republic Day 1950, reorganisation 1956. Prime Ministers in the same order: Shobha Ram, Gokul Lal Asawa, Manikya Lal Verma, Heera Lal Shastri — 'SGMH', and the last of them becomes the first Chief Minister.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the Matsya Union, the first stage in the integration of Rajasthan, was formed on? Answer: 18 March 1948.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — who was the Prime Minister of the Matsya Union? Answer: Shobha Ram.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2024 as an ordering question — arrange the stages of integration. The order is Matsya Union, Rajasthan Union, Sanyukt Rajasthan, Vrihad Rajasthan.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — who was the first and only Rajpramukh of Rajasthan? Answer: Sawai Man Singh II of Jaipur.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — Rajasthan's present shape was completed on 1 November 1956, when the first Governor took charge. Who was he? Answer: Gurumukh Nihal Singh.

The two 1948 unions — do not mix them up

Stage 1 and Stage 2 are one week apart and both are called unions. Every year a question exploits that. Fix them side by side once and you will never lose the mark.

Matsya Union vs Rajasthan Union

Matsya Union — 18 Mar 1948	Rajasthan Union — 25 Mar 1948
Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli	Kota, Bundi, Tonk, Jhalawar, Dungarpur, Banswara, Pratapgarh, Kishangarh, Shahpura
Plus the Neemrana chiefship	Plus the Kushalgarh chiefship
Capital: Alwar	Capital: Kota
Rajpramukh: Udaybhan Singh of Dholpur	Rajpramukh: Bhim Singh of Kota
PM: Shobha Ram	PM: Gokul Lal Asawa
Inaugurated by N.V. Gadgil	Merged into Sanyukt Rajasthan a month later
Stayed separate till 15 May 1949	Absorbed Udaipur on 18 Apr 1948

Two riders. Kishangarh sat in the RAJASTHAN Union, not the Matsya Union — 'which was NOT a constituent of the Matsya Union' is a live question and Kishangarh is the answer. And the name Matsya comes from the ancient Matsya janapada of that eastern tract, not from any modern district.

Loose ends of integration — units, capital, Rajpramukh, Sironj

A handful of separate facts hang off the integration story, and each one has been made into a question.

- Rajasthan was formed out of 19 princely states, 3 chiefships — Neemrana, Kushalgarh and Lava — and the Chief Commissioner's province of Ajmer-Merwara.
- Sawai Man Singh II of Jaipur was the first and the ONLY Rajpramukh of Rajasthan.
- The office of Rajpramukh was abolished by the 7th Constitutional Amendment in 1956.
- V.P. Menon, Secretary of the States Ministry, executed the mergers under Sardar Patel.
- The capital question was settled in favour of Jaipur on the recommendation of a committee headed by B.R. Patel.
- Sirohi was split — Abu and Delwara first went to Bombay in 1950 and came back to Rajasthan only in 1956.
- Sironj went OUT of Rajasthan to Madhya Pradesh in 1956; Sunel Tappa came IN.

TRAP

In and out on 1 November 1956: Ajmer-Merwara IN, Abu Road IN, Delwara IN, Sunel Tappa IN — Sironj OUT. If a question asks what did NOT become part of Rajasthan in 1956, the answer is Sironj.

TRAP

Heera Lal Shastri was Prime Minister of Vrihad Rajasthan and then the first Chief Minister of Rajasthan. He was never Governor. Bhupal Singh of Mewar was Maharajpramukh, never the second Rajpramukh — there was no second Rajpramukh.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Rajasthan Diwas is no longer fixed to 30 March. From 2025 the state government observes it on Chaitra Shukla Pratipada, the Hindu new year; in 2025 the two coincided on 30 March, and in 2026 it was observed on 19 March. The historical fact is unchanged — Vrihad Rajasthan was formed on 30 March 1949. Read the question carefully: 'formation date' is 30 March 1949, 'celebration date' now moves each year.

REVISION RECAP

1. Jaipur Prajamandal 1931, Kapoor Chand Patni — first in Rajasthan; reorganised 1936–38 by Heera Lal Shastri.
2. Marwar 1934 — Jai Narayan Vyas and Bhanwar Lal Sarraf; Marwar Hitkarini Sabha 1938; Balmukund Bissa died in jail 1942.
3. Bikaner 1936 — Magharam Vaidya, founded at Calcutta because of the ban at home.
4. Mewar 1938 — Manikya Lal Verma, banned and revived 1941; Sirohi 1939 — Gokul Bhai Bhatt; Kota 1939 — Nayanuram Sharma; Dungarpur 1944 — Bhogilal Pandya; Jaisalmer 1945 — Mithalal Vyas.
5. Rajputana Madhya Bharat Sabha 1918 (Delhi session, Jamnalal Bajaj, HQ Ajmer); Rajasthan Seva Sangh 1919 Wardha (Pathik).
6. AISPC 1927 Bombay; Nehru presided at Ludhiana 1939. Deshi Rajya Lok Parishad first session Ajmer 1931, Ram Narayan Chaudhary.
7. Mazahrul-Saroor, Bharatpur 1849 — earliest newspaper of Rajasthan; Rajputana Gazette, Ajmer 1885, Maulvi Murad Ali.
8. Pathik's papers: Rajasthan Kesari (Wardha 1920), Naveen Rajasthan (Ajmer 1922, organ of Seva Sangh).
9. Tyag Bhumi 1927, Haribhau Upadhyaya — later CM of Ajmer state 1952–56. Vyas's papers: Agnibaan, Akhand Bharat, Tarun Rajasthan.

10. Arjun Lal Sethi — Vardhaman Vidyalaya, Jaipur, 1907. Kesari Singh Barhath — 'Chetavani ra Chungatya' 1903, 13 sorthas, Veer Bharat Sabha, jailed at Hazaribagh.
11. Jorawar Singh Barhath — Hardinge bomb attack, Delhi, 23 Dec 1912; Pratap Singh Barhath died in Bareilly jail. Women: Ratan Devi, Anjana Devi Chaudhary, Kishori Devi, Narayani Devi Verma, Nagendra Bala.
12. Sagarmal Gopa of Jaisalmer — 'Jaisalmer ka Gundaraj', died in jail 4 April 1946; Rao Gopal Singh Kharwa of Ajmer-Merwara.
13. Seven stages: 18-3-48 Matsya, 25-3-48 Rajasthan Union, 18-4-48 Sanyukt, 30-3-49 Vrihad, 15-5-49 Sanyukt Vrihad, 26-1-50 Rajasthan, 1-11-56 Punargathit.
14. PMs in order: Shobha Ram, Gokul Lal Asawa, Manikya Lal Verma, Heera Lal Shastri.
15. Rajpramukhs of the unions: Udaybhan Singh (Matsya), Bhim Singh (Rajasthan Union), Bhupal Singh (Sanyukt), Sawai Man Singh II (Vrihad onward).
16. Vrihad Rajasthan inaugurated by Sardar Patel, 30 March 1949 — the historical Rajasthan Day; Sanyukt Rajasthan by Nehru; Matsya Union by N.V. Gadgil.
17. Matsya merger 15 May 1949 on the Shankar Rao Deo committee's recommendation; Sirohi merged 26 Jan 1950, Abu and Delwara going to Bombay.
18. 1 Nov 1956: Ajmer-Merwara, Abu Road, Delwara and Sunel Tappa in; Sironj out to MP; Rajpramukh abolished by the 7th Amendment.
19. 19 princely states + 3 chiefships (Neemrana, Kushalgarh, Lava) + Ajmer-Merwara = Rajasthan. Capital Jaipur on the B.R. Patel committee's advice.
20. Sawai Man Singh II — first and only Rajpramukh; Gurumukh Nihal Singh — first Governor; Heera Lal Shastri — first Chief Minister.